KAN VATAN

BLOOD AT THE ROOTS

a pilot for an original series

written by

Max Coyne-Green

November 11, 2026

Olive trees rule the rocky hillside.

For a thousand years, they've grown together. Roots sharing resources. Branches interweaving, even joining over time. These are the natural gods of the land.

But black spots mark their green leaves.

SUPER: **HATAY PROVINCE - 2013**

CRUNCH of dead brown leaves under bare feet.

DAVUT (70s) stumbles down the hill from a stone farmhouse. Terrified. Huffing and puffing. Body stronger than mind. Cutting his unprotected soles on rocky ground.

It's barely dawn. Still dark enough to hide in the trees...

...from chasing FOOTSTEPS...which slow nearby.

Davut holds his breath. Grips a SHARP BRANCH as a--

HAND GRABS his shoulder from behind.

Davut swings and STABS at--

SEZEN (O.S.)
Baba. It's--

SEZEN (30). Just missing her neck.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
--me.

His fear becomes confusion...then embarrassment as he recognizes his daughter. They speak in **Turkish (bold).**

DAVUT
Someone was chasing me.

She sighs, pats her father's back. *Sure, Baba.*

Then gently takes his arm, leads him up the hill...

...bare feet trailing red blood in the dirt.

MATCH CUT TO:

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - DAWN

Red mud under hiking boots, 30km south.

A BACKPACKER (30s) stops at a mountain vista.

SUPER: **YAYLADAĞI CROSSING, TURKISH-SYRIAN BORDER**

He bends to pick wild yarrow, revealing a THICK SCAR on his neck. Wraps the flowers in a cloth. Wipes his muddy hands on his pants, grabs his backpack...and walks down the mountain.

A SHRIEK pierces the sky. He stops. Turns toward the sound.

A JACKAL

bleeds in the forest. On its side.

The backpacker approaches, low and slow. The jackal SNAPS at him. But drops its head, exhausted.

He touches the Jackal's back. Its eyes relax. A moment of peace. Then he finds the wound. A bullet hole.

Shit.

A BULLET slices the air above them. He drops flat. Next to the Jackal. Eye to eye. They breathe together as--

MEN SHOUT through the trees.

He jumps to his feet. Sprints through dense pines. About to get away until he TRIPS over a root and SMACKS his skull on a tree. Vision blurs. When he looks up--

RIFLES point down.

CUT TO:

TWO HUNTERS

drag the jackal through the trees...and the backpacker. Mouth and hands bound with rope.

Ahead: a third hunter dumps wood into a fire pit.

BLACK SMOKE rises into the sky.

INT. TURKISH JANDARMA - SURVEILLANCE ROOM - SAME

BLACK SMOKE fills a monitor. A DRONE PILOT watches the live footage. Flies the drone toward the fire-pit. Below, he sees:

Hunters dragging a jackal...and a backpacker.

DRONE PILOT
Commander?

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - SAME

The hunters throw the backpacker down against the fire-pit. He feels heat on his back. Flames lick his bound wrists.

One hunter digs through his bag. Finds a compass. The yarrow wrapped in cloth. A phrasebook - Arabic, Turkish, Kurdish.

INT. TURKISH JANDARMA - SURVEILLANCE ROOM - SAME

A COMMANDER looks over the Pilot's shoulder, drinking tea.

DRONE PILOT
Looks like a hippie got lost on the wrong side of the mountain.

COMMANDER
(sigh, sipping tea)
May God protect him.

The Commander turns to leave but--

DRONE PILOT
Wait.

On the monitor: The backpacker is standing. Ropes at his feet. The hunters finally notice. Then--

Monitor fills with sudden movement.

Too fast to follow. Smoke clouding the image.

COMMANDER
Pull back!

WIDER SHOT

Stillness. All three hunters on the ground. Not moving. Fire burning. No sign of the backpacker.

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - SAME

The backpacker sprints down the mountain. As he turns back to look at the drone, he SLICES his arm against a jagged pine tree. But keeps running deeper into the forest.

Blood drips off his arm...onto the gnarled roots.

TITLE:

KAN VATAN
BLOOD AT THE ROOTS

ACT I

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAWN

The sun climbs above the trees. Shining onto Sezen as steps out of the back door in her work clothes. She proceeds to a:

BLUE TENT

and sees a sleeping bag, family photos, and torn pages from an Arabic-English teaching guide.

MUSA is already awake. He's about 15, skinny as a cypress.

SEZEN
Günaydın.

The boy squints. She nods to the rising sun. Uses English:

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Morning.

He nods and responds in *Arabic (italic)*.

MUSA
Sabah.

IN THE GROVE

Musa inspects the leaves of an olive tree. Black spots.

Sezen looks over his shoulder. Then carefully picks a leaf - it crumbles immediately.

MUSA
Mayyit. Dead.

She sighs, responding in Turkish.

SEZEN
I know.

HOSES

unroll from an equipment shed.

Musa drags them to the worst trees. Sezen repositions them along grooves of the roots.

She returns to the shed. Turns the valve. Water flows.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - LATER THAT MORNING

WATER FLOWS as Sezen fills a glass. Then she grabs grabs a big fat fig, heads outside.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - CONTINUOUS

She hands a glass of water to Musa.

SEZEN
Drink.

Then splits the fig, hands him a half. He waits until she takes a bite of the fruit, but--

BACK DOOR swings open. Davut emerges. Dressed for work. He inhales. Finds his way to the nearest trunk. Touches it.

DAVUT
The sun is kind today.

He looks at the shining sun, as Sezen approaches. Davut brushes her cheek. Gentle. Present.

DAVUT (CONT'D)
Your mother said to appreciate it before it goes away.
(face shifting)
I'm late.

He walks into the grove. She chases after.

SEZEN
Baba. The doctor is coming today. He said to rest until he sees you.

DAVUT
There is work to be done.

SEZEN
Musa and I are handling it.

Davut stops. Turns to Musa. Musa tries to avoid his gaze.

DAVUT
I don't like his old eyes.

SEZEN
We need his help.

DAVUT
Help comes for harvest. That's how it's worked for seven generations.

SEZEN
It won't work if we can't make it to harvest. The trees are sick.

DAVUT
What would you know? You're barely 12 years old.

Davut disappears into the grove...leaving Sezen speechless. With sympathy, Musa offers his half of the fig.

DAVUT (O.S.)
(from down the hill)
Tell your brother I need him!

Sezen sighs. She takes a sour bite of fig.

KAAN (PRE-LAP)
I'm at work.

INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

KAAN (32) sits before MONITORS FLASHING with financial data. Talking to Sezen. Outside, the Manhattan skyline twinkles.

SEZEN (PHONE)
It's 11pm there.

KAAN
Midnight. But Peter's on a warpath. He's about to fire my new analyst. Kid barely made it a week.

Kaan peeks into an office: boss PETER yells at young JIMMY.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - SAME

Sezen CHOPS vegetables, phone pinched to ear. She makes a sarcastic face. He somehow knows.

KAAN (PHONE)
Sezen. This is serious.

SEZEN
***This* is serious. There's something wrong with our trees.**

Sezen looks into the living room: Davut watches TV. Loudly. She switches to English, just in case.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
And Baba thinks I'm 12 years old.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - CONTINUOUS

Sezen drags garbage outside. Gusting wind rattles leaves.

KAAN (PHONE)
He's just old fashioned.

SEZEN
No, Kaan, I mean--
(as he talks to someone)
Kaan!

INT. HEDGE FUND - SAME

Kaan quickly finishes his conversation with a colleague and returns to the call with Sezen.

KAAN
Sorry. Just tell me what you need.

SEZEN (PHONE)
HELP!

This is loud. He checks around. Then sneaks to the window.

KAAN
Relax. I can pay someone--

SEZEN (PHONE)
Money doesn't solve everything.

Another colleague passes. Kaan pretends it's a business call:

KAAN
It has a pretty high hit rate.

No response. Kaan hears the wind whipping through his family's trees. It settles him. He switches back to Turkish:

KAAN
Listen. I'll find a maid. Or a nurse. Or a nurse who cleans.

SEZEN (PHONE)
He already has one of those.

Sezen hangs up. Kaan holds the phone for a beat. Then sees Jimmy race out of Peter's office. Face red.

BATHROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Kaan looks for Jimmy. Finds shoes under the stall door.

KAAN
Jimmy? What happened in there?

JIMMY (O.S.)
I'm a fucking idiot.

Kaan leans on a sink. Impatient. Forces a Big Brother tone.

KAAN
You're not a *fucking idiot*. Just tell me what Peter said.

JIMMY (O.S.)
That my pitch would make good fertilizer.

KAAN
(snapping to stall door)
What.

STALL

Jimmy's on the toilet, not using it. Wallowing in self-pity.

JIMMY
Because it's dogshit.

Kaan suddenly appears over the stall door.

KAAN
No. Jimmy. I mean: why are you pitching Peter?

JIMMY
Oh. Um. Navroz said I should tell him about the chicken--

KAAN
Chicken? God damnit, dude.

BACK TO BATHROOM

Kaan bangs the stall door in frustration.

KAAN (CONT'D)
I shut down chicken for a reason. Nav is trying to get you fired.

JIMMY (O.S.)
I don't understand. It's a real opportunity. This bird flu is crazy. The CDC says--

KAAN
Exactly, *"the CDC says".* You're not the only one who can read. And this isn't fucking Fidelity.
(settling himself)
Listen. I know you're new to this. But we make money by betting *against* consensus. We have to know what others don't.

Jimmy opens the stall door. Nervous.

JIMMY
And that's like...okay?

KAAN
What are you saying?

JIMMY
Nothing--

KAAN
Then say nothing.

Kaan closes the stall door on his face. Mutters:

KAAN (CONT'D)
Fucking idiot.

HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

Kaan marches out, right into Peter - who checks his watch.

PETER
Seven minutes in the bathroom. Are you eating our fiber snacks?
(off Kaan's slow nod)
Good. Because things are getting clogged up around here. I promised the partners I'd clear some space.

KAAN
Jimmy has potential--

PETER
Jimmy is cheap. Relatively.

He claps Kaan's shoulder. Hard. Unimpressed by the muscles.

PETER
Find me something good, Kaan.
(squeezing shoulder)
Before I find someone better.

EXT. SYRIAN BORDER - DAY

The backpacker races down the mountain.

Hides in a group of pine trees. Catches breath.

Listens. Doesn't hear anything. Grabs a cell phone from his bag. Unclips his belt buckle. Pulls out a hidden SIM CARD.

Slots it in the phone. SCREEN LIGHTS UP. He calls a number...

This is ABE. But for now, he's known as:

MARCY (PHONE)
Coyote. You're late.

ABE
I was making friends.

MARCY (PHONE)
I know.

ABE
Civilians I think. Just some hunters by the border.

CRACKING SOUND

MARCY (PHONE)
I know.

ABE
But there were other eyes.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

CRACK goes a pistachio between razor sharp teeth.

MARCY (O.S.)
Coyote. I know.

The piercing eyes of MARCY (AKA SNAPPER, height: 4'11") watch tapped Turkish drone footage from the jandarma station.

MARCY (CONT'D)
The drone belongs to border control. They've already alerted Turkish intelligence.

EXT. HATAY PROVINCE - SAME

A government-issued sedan drives to the border station.

MARCY (V.O.)(CONT'D)
MIT Inspector Mehmet Demir is on his way now.

ABE (V.O.)
You're familiar?

EXT. TURKISH JANDARMA - GATE - SAME

MEHMET DEMIR (55, rumpled suit) hands over his badge, revealing a missing ring finger on his left hand.

The badge reads: MIT - Counterterrorism.

MARCY (V.O.)
Let me handle the Turks. All you need to do is ride with Brando, ensure a clean delivery, and get back across the border before--

ABE (V.O.)
Before I get killed.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

Marcy jumps down from her chair.

MARCY (CONT'D)
This isn't Anbar. I'm not worried about you getting killed. If you get taken, we can't ask for you back.

A long silence on the line.

ABE (PHONE)
I know.

EXT. SYRIAN HIGHWAY - SAME

A white AID TRUCK rumbles down the bombed-out highway.

HUMANITARIAN RELIEF INTERNATIONAL in Arabic and English.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - CONTINUOUS

WILL (40, AKA BRANDO) sings along with AMERICAN CLASSIC ROCK on the radio. Driving one-handed. Hawaiian shirt over tactical vest. He pulls over to the side of the road.

DOOR OPENS. Abe pokes his head in.

ABE
Brando?

WILL
Just get in the truck.

INT. TURKISH JANDARMA - HALLWAY - DAY

Demir marches down the hall with the COMMANDER.

COMMANDER
He doesn't look like a terrorist.

DEMIR
And what does a terrorist look like to you, Commander?

Demir stops at a door. Turns back to the Commander.

DEMIR (CONT'D)
It's been three months since Reyhanlı and we have exactly zero suspects. We need to be taking all leads extremely seriously.

COMMANDER
(intimidated but offended)
Of course, Inspector. We <u>are</u> taking this extremely seriously.

He opens the door to the:

SURVEILLANCE ROOM

where SOLDIERS are hooting and hollering. Watching <u>DRONE FOOTAGE</u> of Abe taking down the Hunters at the border.

DRONE PILOT
Wait. This is my favorite part!

On the monitor, Demir sees:

Abe swiftly disarming each of the hunters. Then escaping.

SOLDIER
Play it again!

COMMANDER
That's enough!

DEMIR
Do it.

Pilot looks at the Commander, who nods. He plays the footage. Demir rubs his missing ring finger as he watches Abe's precise motions. Notices the scar on Abe's neck.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

The scar on Abe's neck rattles as Will races the truck down the cracked highway.

WILL
Unclench your asshole. It's only 48 hours. And I only get paid if I send you back alive.

EXPLOSION in the distance. Abe swings to look.

WILL (CONT'D)
Just breathe. In for four. Hold for four. Out for four. I'm serious.

Abe tries it. *In, hold, out.* His heart rate slows down.

Will pulls the truck to the side of the road.

Abe stiffens.

WILL (CONT'D)
Hey. What'd I just tell you?

RIFLES ON THE WINDOWS

WILL (CONT'D)
Breathe.

Will puts down the window. Smiles at the armed men.

30 SECONDS LATER

The aid truck drives away from the checkpoint.

WILL
I feed people around here. And everyone likes the breadman.

ABE
So they're regime?

Will shrugs. *Does it matter?*

ABE (CONT'D)
I'm just trying to keep track of who the good guys and bad guys are.

WILL
Look around, Coyote.

They pass under a bridge where DEAD BODIES HANG.

WILL (CONT'D)
The good guys are all dead.

Blood drips onto the truck.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

EXPLOSIONS on the news from Syria on TV. Bombings. Refugees.

A DOCTOR (50s) examines Davut on the sofa.

DOCTOR
Can you turn that down?

Davut doesn't hear. Doctor grabs a remote. Turns off the TV. Then puts his hand on Davut's leg. Deep breath.

DOCTOR (CONT'D)
You need rest. At least until we know more.

Davut pushes the Doctor's hand aside. Rises unevenly. Ambles to the window. The Doctor knows better than to try to help.

DAVUT
My father died right on his ladder. It was a fine harvest that year.

DOCTOR
I am a man of science, Davut Bey, not superstition.

KITCHEN - SAME

Sezen chops vegetables. Can overhear from the other room.

DAVUT (O.S.)
Balance is a natural fact, Doctor. There is no life without death. We give, and the trees give back.

DOCTOR (O.S.)
But you are not the only one in this family with something to give. Let Sezen handle the grove until harvest. She's more capable than you assume.

Silence. Sezen doesn't hear a response.

Then the Doctor steps out, to the front door. He looks back at her, opens his mouth, closes it. Then leaves.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - NIGHT

Sezen's washing her father's clothes when she hears HOWLING.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen steps outside. There's blue in the sky, but the grove is dark. She hears the HOWLING again.

Musa scrambles out of a small tent. Alert. Scared.

SEZEN
It's that jackal. Go to the house.

He wavers. She touches his shoulder. Enunciates in English.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Relax. He's asleep.

EQUIPMENT SHED

Sezen opens a wooden chest. Pulls out an ancient REVOLVER.

IN THE GROVE

She moves deeper into the trees, gripping the revolver.

After a moment, she hears RUSTLING in the trees.

COCKS the gun as--

A YOUNG MAN named ROB emerges from behind a tree. Hands up. He's wearing a safari hat with flaps on the back. Shaking.

SOIL SAMPLE TUBES scatter at his feet.

ROB
Lütfen! Don't shoot. I don't know how to say that in Turkish yet--

SEZEN
What the fuck are you doing here?

ROB
Thank god you speak English--

SEZEN
(gripping gun tighter)
Answer the question.

ROB
Um I'm a PhD student doing research for an American ag-tech company. I was collecting samples and I guess I got turned around. Look--

Rob reaches down. But Sezen holds the gun up.

ROB (CONT'D)
I swear. I can show you.

A long beat. She lowers the gun.

He quickly pulls out an envelope from his bag. Hands it over. It's addressed to Davut. From TERRASOURCE.

ROB (CONT'D)
We've been reaching out for weeks. We want to help save your trees.

SEZEN
Save them from what?

He's confused. *She really doesn't know?*

SEZEN (PRE-LAP)
It's a blight.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - BACK DOOR - NIGHT

Sezen digs through the trash. Phone pinched to ear.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Rob says it's all over Hatay.

KAAN (PHONE)
But who even is this guy?

SEZEN
The researcher. I just told you. You're not even listening.

KAAN (PHONE)
Of course I'm listening.

INT. HEDGE FUND - DAY

Kaan's not really listening. He's researching chicken prices.

KAAN (CONT'D)
I'm just saying it's weird. Going around to every grove. It sounds like he's selling snake oil.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - BACK DOOR - SAME

Sezen pulls envelopes from the trash. Unopened. Addressed to DAVUT YILMAZ.

SEZEN (PHONE)
He works for a serious agricultural technology company. American.

She finds the TERRASOURCE logo.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Terrasource.

KAAN
What?

SEZEN
Kaan. Listen to me.

INT. HEDGE FUND - SAME

Kaan is definitely listening now. On monitors: Terrasource stock. Research on olive trees and diseases.

KAAN
Sorry. Yeah. I know them. That's a real play. What the fuck are they doing in Hatay?

SEZEN (PHONE)
They have some kind of cure. Rob said it could save millions of trees, starting with ours.

KAAN
And it actually works?

Kaan squints at the market cap data. Peeks at Peter's office.

SEZEN (PHONE)
Rob's certain it will. And they're willing to provide the scion wood and do the grafting themselves.

KAAN
What. No.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - BACK DOOR - SAME

Sezen does NOT like this tone.

SEZEN
Excuse me?

KAAN (PHONE)
Sezen. These companies are pirates. No one gives anything for free.

SEZEN
You gave up your vote when you left, Kaan.

KAAN (PHONE)
But I can still be helpful. Please. Let me do some research. And then we can look over the offer together. As a family.

INT. HEDGE FUND - SAME

Silence. Kaan grinds his teeth, anxious. Eager.

KAAN (CONT'D)
Sezen?

SEZEN (PHONE)
Whatever you say, brother.

Call ends.

Kaan thinks. Looks at Peter's office. Throws a pen at Jimmy.

KAAN
What do you know about olive trees?

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - KITCHEN - NIGHT

Sezen returns inside with several letters from TERRASOURCE.

Waiting at the table, Davut with the contract Rob left behind. He seems unusually lucid.

SEZEN
That came today. Why wouldn't you tell me they've been writing?

DAVUT
They're snakes, Sezen. Foreign predators who want our land.

SEZEN
They're scientists, Baba. They know what they're doing--

DAVUT
But you do not!

Davut gets to his feet. Slides the contract to the floor.

DAVUT (CONT'D)
And this conversation is over. Put that all back in the garbage where it belongs.

He ambles out.

DAVUT (CONT'D)
And tell Sezen to run me a bath.

She sighs. Goddamnit.

BATHTUB - LATER

Sezen helps her father into the bath.

Runs a cloth over him. Lifts his foot out of the water. The sole is cut open from the hillside. She cleans the wound. He winces. Lets her. The water turns pink.

When he's finished, she wraps him in a towel.

DAVUT'S BEDROOM - AFTER THAT

Sezen puts him to bed. On her way out:

DAVUT
Sezen. We have a responsibility to make hard choices for our family. Even when we disagree.

SEZEN
I know.

Sezen turns out the lights. Closes the door.

KITCHEN

Sezen picks up the contract off the ground. Looks at it for a while.

Then signs the name DAVUT YILMAZ.

ACT II

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - NIGHT

LEYLA (22) chops vegetables. Dumps them in the lamb stew. Dark hair pulled back, moving with nervous efficiency.

She reaches for spices on a high shelf, revealing a thick scar around her ankle. Like a chain.

A TRUCK RUMBLES to the house. She smooths her dress.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - SAME

Outside, the aid truck pulls up to a LOW-WALLED COMPOUND. RAZOR WIRE tops the walls. Security cameras at corners.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - CONTINUOUS

Abe follows Will inside. It’s nice. Tile floors, high ceilings, a big TV. On the table: English language workbooks.

LEYLA (O.S.)
Dinner is one half hour.

Leyla appears in the kitchen doorway. She has a thick accent.

WILL
No “one”. Just “half hour”.

Will grabs a bottle of Arak, nods for Abe to follow outside.

Leyla studies Abe as he passes.

EXT. WILL’S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - CONTINUOUS

Olive groves surround the house, silver-green in darkness. Will pours two glasses of Arak. Hands one to Abe.

WILL
I’m helping with her English. She thinks she’s gonna move to America.

ABE
No family?

WILL
She’s got a kid brother working some olive grove in Hatay. The rest are dead. If they’re lucky.

Abe follows Will’s eyes back to the kitchen window, where Leyla’s watching. She quickly turns away.

HOWL from the trees.

Will's hand moves to an electric CATTLE PROD on his belt.

WILL
Fucking jackals. They come for the dead.

He listens. No more howling. He releases the cattle prod.

INT. WILL’S COMPOUND - LEYLA’S ROOM - SAME

LIGHTS ON as Leyla sits at her small desk. Sets down her workbook. Flips the pages until she finds:

Hidden photos. Faded. A family. Parents. Younger siblings.

And a map. Their location in Syria circled.

With a line that goes across the border...to Hatay Province.

JIMMY (PRE-LAP)
It’s a trail of death.

INT. HEDGE FUND - CONFERENCE ROOM - DAY

Jimmy shows Kaan SATELLITE IMAGES of Hatay Province.

Black canopies spreading across the region like a plague.

JIMMY (CONT'D)
I tracked social media complaints about dying trees and matched them to satellite imaging. The disease is coming from the border.

KAAN
And Terrasource?

JIMMY
They already sell disease-resistant cultivars in Spain and Greece. But there’s no public info about their entry into Turkey.

Jimmy smirks.

KAAN
So why are you smiling?

Jimmy flips a laptop. A press release from the Penn State Department of Plant Science. Terrasource logo. "Exploring foreign scion integration with endemic rootstock."

JIMMY
This is the same team that did their phase one testing in Greece. Can you see where they are?

Kaan scans the photo. Behind the group, there's a road sign with distance markers for GAZIANTEP and ADANA.

Then he looks back at the group. The faces. Then the caption with the names, including: ROB GREEN, PhD CANDIDATE. Bingo.

KAAN
Compile the research. Now.
(slapping Jimmy's back)
We take this to Peter tonight.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S BEDROOM - MORNING

Sezen watches SUNRISE through a crack in the shades. On the side of the property, a car pulls into the driveway.

Her father turns over in bed. She closes the shades. Then unplugs his alarm clock. Kisses him on the head.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DRIVEWAY - CONTINUOUS

Rob unloads his rental car. Ladder. Grafting knives. A cooler of scion wood wrapped in wet burlap.

Sezen hurries out. Keeps her voice low.

SEZEN
Start in the far rows.

ROB
The worst trees are by the house.

SEZEN
Just start with the far rows.

Rob looks at Davut's shuttered window. Back at Sezen.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
He's not feeling well. I don't want to wake him up.

Rob shrugs. Good enough. Hoists the ladder down the hill.

Sezen follows, passing Musa in the shed.

SEZEN
If Baba wakes up, come find me.

He’s confused. The English is too advanced.

SEZEN
Father come, you say.

INT. HATAY HOTEL ROOM - MORNING

LIGHT from Demir’s cell phone flashes. The name “ELIF”.

It’s early. But Demir hasn’t slept. He’s studying evidence of the Reyhanlı car bombings pinned to his wall. Surveillance photos, blast sites, faces of victims.

The phone rings out. Then starts ringing again. He sighs.

A FEW MINUTES LATER

Demir speaks with his daughter, ELIF.

ELIF (PHONE)
But it’s on Saturday. You promised.

DEMIR
I said I would do my best.

ELIF (PHONE)
Well do better, Baba. This is my graduation.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

Marcy quietly eats pistachios as she listens to the call.

DEMIR (V.O.)
And this is my job. Please don’t make it harder than it needs to be.

ELIF (V.O.)
You’re the one who makes it hard.

INT. HATAY HOTEL ROOM - SAME

Call ends. Demir sighs, puts down the phone. Then looks back to a photo on his wall. Abe’s face - from the drone footage.

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

Abe looks out the window. To the ocean.

Will’s truck is finally arriving at the PORT. Cranes GROAN overhead. Armed guards milling about.

WILL
Stay in the truck.

A FERRY docks ahead. Same HUMANITARIAN RELIEF INTERNATIONAL logo as Will's aid truck. A customs OFFICER greets Will with kisses on both cheeks.

MINUTES LATER

Abe watches through the window. Talking to Marcy.

MARCY (PHONE)
Brando’s behaving himself?

DOCKWORKERS move crates from ferry to Will’s aid truck. Food supplies on top. Will supervises. Joking with the Officer.

Beneath the food: STEEL GLIMMERS in the sunlight.

ABE
I thought you trusted him.

MARCY (PHONE)
I trust his incentives. He’s not one of ours.

ABE
Neither am I.
(off her silence)
Just explain how I get out of here tomorrow. Will MIT be looking for me at the border?

MARCY (PHONE)
We’ll send you the other way.

ABE
What. No. I’m not going back--

MARCY (PHONE)
We don’t have a choice. If you get picked up in Syria--

ABE
(opening door)
I know.

LOADING DOCK - CONTINUOUS

Abe slams the door of the truck. Heads for a bathroom.

A HAND clamps his shoulder from behind. Abe SPINS and body coils. Arm cocked. Ready to strike--

A YOUNG GUARD. Barely twenty. Confused.

WILL (O.S.)
Easy.

Will wraps Abe around the hips. Smiles at the guard.

BACK IN THE TRUCK - A MINUTE LATER

Will slams the door from inside.

WILL
I said stay in the truck.

ABE
I have to piss.

WILL
And I have to keep you alive.

SURVEILLANCE ROOM - SAME

A CUSTOMS OFFICER watches the truck drive away. Then checks the security footage. Rewinds to Abe’s near-fight.

He pauses on Abe’s face. Picks up a phone.

INT. HEDGE FUND - PETER'S OFFICE - NIGHT

Peter does pull-ups. Kaan and Jimmy in chairs, pitching.

PETER
A cure for sick trees. Does this look like a charity?

KAAN
It’s a lucrative opportunity. The disease is wrecking acres of profitable land the size of small countries, as we speak. And nobody else with Terrasource’s capabilities is even present in the region. Whatever they have, they’re years ahead of the competition.

Peter hops off the bar. Flops behind his desk.

KAAN (CONT'D)
There are millions of olive trees in Hatay province alone. And the blight creates concentrated demand. If we get the timing right with short-dated calls before the panic starts, a bump is a windfall.

PETER
You sound remarkably certain.

KAAN
My family's seen it themselves.

PETER
Fuck your family, Kaan. I'm talking about Terrasource. How do you know they have a market-ready solution?

Kaan considers his response. Peter assesses him. Then:

PETER
Jimmy. Get us coffee.

JIMMY
I thought you didn't drink caff--

Peter glares at him. He scurries out. Kaan opens his mouth--

PETER
Don't speak. Is it real or not?

Kaan nods. It's real.

PETER (CONT'D)
Then we'll execute tomorrow.

Peter rises. Kaan flinches. *Tomorrow?*

PETER (CONT'D)
Is that a problem?

Kaan quickly shakes his head.

PETER (CONT'D)
Good. Because if you fuck me, I will burn your life to the ground.

Kaan quickly nods. Peter smiles. He grips Kaan's shoulder.

PETER (CONT'D)
Let's save some fucking trees.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - FAR ROWS - DAY

Sezen walks through the trees. Phone to her ear.

SEZEN
I'm busy.

KAAN (PHONE)
I just wanted to let you know I looked into Terrasource. And I'm impressed. But we need to be careful. We can't be test rabbits.

SEZEN
We're running out of time.

KAAN (PHONE)
I know that. I do. But these R&D contracts are complicated. One vague clause and they own everything on our soil. Forever.

INT. HEDGE FUND - NIGHT

Kaan peeks into Peter's office.

KAAN (CONT'D)
Listen. I can come home next month. We'll look at it together.

SEZEN (PHONE)
You're coming home?

KAAN
Isn't that what you want?

SEZEN (PHONE)
I'm handling things on my own.

KAAN
But you don't have to. You already do too much.

Silence. Kaan bites his lip. Waiting. Getting nothing.

KAAN (CONT'D)
Just don't let Baba sign anything. We'll do this as a family.

The waiting continues. Painfully.

SEZEN (PHONE)
Okay, Kaan. I'll see you soon.

Kaan exhales. Hangs up. Smiles, relieved.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAY

Sezen hangs up, thinking.

ROB (O.S.)
Everything okay?

She looks at Rob, on a ladder, sawing dead limbs off a tree. The dead limb drops at her feet.

SEZEN
You tell me.

Rob cuts the diseased branch. Hands it to her. Dark and soft. Then makes a careful incision on the exposed surface.

ROB
These strains are what, 500 years old? A thousand? They have no natural defense against this.
(beat)
Can you ask Musa to pass that?

Musa grabs a branch, wrapped in plastic. Hands it to Rob.

SEZEN
He knows some English.

MUSA
My sister. Teach.

SEZEN
So what happens now? You just replace the top?

ROB
Not replacing. *Joining*. The trees come and go. But the roots are basically immortal. We're just giving them the best of the foreign stock so they can battle the disease and keep growing.

Rob slides the scion wood into the incision on the tree.

Just then, Musa notices a green Turkish JANDARMA TRUCK grumbles toward the house. He taps Sezen.

SEZEN
(to Rob)
Stay up there. Don't move.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
(whispering to Musa)
House. Go. Quiet.

MUSA
But Davut Bey--

SEZEN
Just go.

Musa runs low through the trees toward the back door.

DRIVEWAY - MOMENTS LATER

The truck stops besides Rob's car. Two JANDARMA SOLDIERS climb out. Then the COMMANDER from the border station.

Sezen approaches from the grove, wiping her hands.

COMMANDER
İyi günler, may I speak speak with the owner of the property?

SEZEN
How can I help you, Commander?

COMMANDER
You're the owner?

SEZEN
He's ill. What's this about?

COMMANDER
A foreigner.

Sezen flinches. But he hands her a grainy photo. She peeks at it. It's not Rob and it's not Musa.

COMMANDER (CONT'D)
Tall, dark hair. Scar on neck. He was close by, at the border.

SEZEN
Is he dangerous?

He doesn't answer. But the answer is obvious.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - SAME

Musa crouches below the window, listening.

COMMANDER (O.S.)
Do you employ foreign laborers?

SEZEN (O.S.)
We don't bring on workers until the harvest. For now, it's just me.

Musa looks at the bedroom door, where Davut sleeps.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DRIVEWAY - SAME

The Commander gives Sezen a long skeptical look.

COMMANDER
Just you?

SEZEN
That's right, Commander. But I'll be certain to let you know if I see anyone suspicious.

The Commander continues looking at her. Then he turns to Rob's car, parked next to his truck. Peers inside...for a long time. Seems to inspect every detail.

COMMANDER
My son has the same car. It's a very reliable vehicle.

He gets back into his truck. The Soliders follow.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - SAME

Musa hears the engine start and the truck drive away.

Then the door opens. Sezen looks at him.

MUSA
For me?

Sezen shakes her head. Then shows him the photo the Commander left her, a grainy still from the drone footage:

SEZEN
For him.

Abe at the fire pit. Face obscured. Scar on his neck.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT./EXT. AID TRUCK - DAY

Abe stares at destruction out the window as Will drives away from the lush coast. Into the heat of the desert.

A BARREL BOMB hits a hillside in the distance.

Abe winces.

WILL
You gonna shit yourself? I thought they pulled you from Iraq.

ABE
I'll be fine.

Will snorts as he pulls over to a CHECKPOINT.

WILL
Don't speak too soon.

GUN BARRELS tap the glass.

The truck is surrounded by masked gunmen.

Will calmly puts the window down. Drops a black bag outside. There's some fumbling with the bag.

GUNMAN
What the fuck is this?

Then a GUNMAN dumps the bag.

GUNMAN (CONT'D)
No Kit Kats?

It's all fun-sized American candy bars.

WILL
Bring us in and you get the rest.

The Gunman opens the door. Nods for Abe to scooch.

Abe scooches into the middle. The Gunman climbs in, lifts his mask to his nose, unwraps a Snickers. Chocolate on his breath. Kalashnikov across his lap.

Abe stares straight ahead. Breathes.

Will drives into the desert until they reach the:

REBEL COMPOUND

Former school. High walls, but the playground is intact.

A BOY chases a soccer ball past a FIGHTER cleaning his rifle.

The Guard waves them through the gate.

EXT. REBEL COMPOUND - LOADING AREA - DAY

The truck is unloaded. Will and Abe help FIGHTERS with CRATES of food. Lentils. Canned goods. Medical supplies.

A desperate-looking MOTHER with two children lingers nearby. Will hands her a heaping bag of rice.

ABE
I'm gonna find the bathroom.

WILL
You really can't wait?

ABE
(walking off)
I've been waiting all day.

INT. REBEL COMPOUND - BATHROOM - A FEW MINUTES LATER

FLUSH. Abe steps back from a tiny urinal. Cartoon fish on the tiles. A faded poster: *WASH YOUR HANDS* in Arabic.

He moves to the sink. Cracked mirror. Water trickles. He splashes his face. Looks at himself. Then walks out into the:

HALLWAY

where children's drawings line the walls.

He peeks inside a:

CLASSROOM

and finds old educational posters. Small desks still in rows. Backpacks on hooks. Like they just left for recess.

Then he notices, on the wall:

A FLAG with the Shahada in white Arabic script. The black flag of Jihad.

His mind flashes. Jaw tightens.

He turns to a window. In the courtyard, he sees Will unloading weapons with fighters. Laughing.

Then he hears VOICES from a closet door.

Abe approaches the door. Stops. Listens.

Hears A CHAIN DRAGGING on the floor. What?

He opens the door to a:

STORAGE ROOM

and finds YOUNG WOMEN sitting against a wall. Teens, at most.

CHAINED by the ankle to bolts in concrete.

One GIRL meets his eyes just as--

FIGHTER (O.S.)
What are you doing!?

Big FIGHTER appears to his left. Kalashnikov raised.

The girl scrambles up, chain rattling:

GIRL
He's lost--

The Fighter quickly SMACKS her with the rifle.

She falls down. Bleeding from her chin.

Abe turns to the Fighter. Eye contact.

FIGHTER
I asked you--

Abe STRIKES the Fighter's throat. Precise. Brutal. Out of pure instinct.

The Fighter drops his rifle, clutching his crushed windpipe--

ABE
Fuck.

Abe reaches for the gun but--

ANOTHER RIFLE CRACKS HIM in the back of the skull.

CUT TO BLACK.

ACT III

OVER BLACK:

Labored BREATHING. Something TIGHTENS. A strangled GASP.

CLOSE UP ON: FINGERS clawing at dirt.

WIDER: Hands bound. Not by rope. But by roots.

DAVUT struggles on his back in the grove. The earth swallowing him.

SMOKE rises.

The trees are BURNING.

A FIGURE approaches through the haze. Carrying a torch.

SEZEN puts her finger to her lips.

SEZEN
Shh.

Then touches the torch to the roots below Davut.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S BEDROOM - DAY

DAVUT wakes from the nightmare. Covered in sweat.

Sezen's waiting beside him. Concerned. It's late afternoon.

SEZEN
Baba. I'm here. Are you okay?
(off silence)
I should call the doctor--

He grips her wrist. Hard. Then releases. Tries to rise.

DAVUT
I'm fine. I have work to do--

SEZEN
I did everything. I swear.
(pressing him down)
I know you won't believe me.

He looks in her eyes. Then shakes off the dream.

DAVUT
I know I am...like vinegar. It is hard being trapped inside my mind.

DAVUT (CONT'D)
(pained breath)
All I see is death.

SEZEN
I know, Baba.

DAVUT
I hope you don't.

INT. REBEL COMPOUND - CLASSROOM - DAY

Abe is bound and gagged.

Bloody crack on his head.

A REBEL ties his hands tight just as Will storms in.

REBEL
You can't be in here.

Will pulls out a handgun.

WILL
Didn't your commander tell you who the fuck I am?

Will BASHES the Rebel over the head with the gun.

WILL (CONT'D)
Let's go.

He pulls Abe off the floor.

WILL (CONT'D)
Fucking idiot.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT'S BEDROOM - DAY

The door eases open. Bare feet on wood.

EXT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - BACK DOOR - CONTINUOUS

Davut steps into the low sun. Heads for the grove.

STONE WALL

Musa sees him. Jumps up. Looks to the far rows: Rob at the top of his ladder. No Sezen.

Davut's already passing him.

Musa steps into his path.

Davut stops. Those old eyes.

DAVUT
Move.

Musa doesn't.

MUSA
You no eat.

Davut squints. Musa tries Turkish:

MUSA
Hungry. You.

Musa pulls a fig from his pocket. Splits it. Holds out half.

Davut looks at the fig. Then the boy. Takes it. A labored breath. Musa helps him sit on the wall.

It's a long uncomfortable silence as Davut's mind wanders. He looks down at the fig.

DAVUT
My father planted these. With his father. He brought life to this land.

MUSA
We have trees too.

DAVUT
I don't understand what you're saying.

Musa doesn't understand, either. He answers in Arabic.

MUSA
They burned.

Davut studies him. Then puts a caring hand on his cheek.

DAVUT
Your eyes. They're too old for a child. What have you seen?

DEEPER IN THE GROVE

Sezen hurries between the trees, arms full of scion wood. Stops dead when she sees:

Davut and Musa on the wall. Backs to the grafts. Sharing a fig. After a moment, Davut heads back toward the house.

Musa catches her eye. The smallest nod.

INT. HEDGE FUND - MORNING

CLINK! Kaan taps a coffee cup to Jimmy’s across their desks.

KAAN
To surviving another day.

JIMMY
What time’s the trade hitting?

KAAN
Whenever Peter pulls the trigger.
(big sip)
I already have to shit.

Kaan sets down the mug. Heads to the bathroom. Moments later:

PETER (O.S.)
Jimmy.

Peter calls over from his office.

PETER’S OFFICE - CONTINUOUS

Jimmy steps in and finds:

PETER
You know Michael Waller, our Chief Compliance Officer.

A suited COMPLIANCE OFFICER sits on the sofa. Doesn’t smile.

PETER (CONT'D)
Let’s talk Turkey.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT’S BEDROOM - EVENING

Sezen leaves rice and chicken by Davut’s bedside. The old man is deep asleep.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - CONTINUOUS

Sezen heads down the hill to Rob, who’s still on the ladder, finishing a final graft.

ROB
Is your father happy?

SEZEN
Not since I was 12.

ROB
(chuckle)
Well. This should be the last one.
Then I can get out of your hair.

SEZEN
You must be starving.

ROB
Oh, no thank you--

SEZEN
That wasn't a question.

Rob smiles. Then tapes around the graft. Pulls it tight.

MATCH CUT TO:

THREAD pulls tight--

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - NIGHT

—-through the gash in Abe's scalp.

Dried blood caked in his hair from the rifle.

WILL (O.S.)
Do you know what the market is like
for Americans here? Especially with
your record.

Will ties off a suture.

A long silence as Abe broods.

ABE
Did you know?

Will keeps stitching. Ignoring the question.

ABE (CONT'D)
Did. You. Know.

The needle stops. Will exhales.

WILL
I warned you about the good guys.

ABE
So what? They’re al-Qaeda?

WILL
Not anymore. They call themselves ISIS now. Sounds like a Toyota, if you ask me. But they’re effective.

Abe groans.

WILL (CONT'D)
Don’t bitch to me. We don’t choose our friends out here. We choose our enemies.
(beat)
And a choice has finally been made. That’s why they sent you.

ABE
Is it?

Will gives him a look through the mirror. What?

ABE (CONT'D)
You could have done this yourself. So what am I? Insurance?

Will doesn’t respond. No use lying. Abe sees the truth.

ABE (CONT'D)
That fucking bitch--

WILL
If it weren’t for her, you’d still be rotting in a cell in Mosul.

Will's phone BUZZES. He ignores it. Starts another suture.

WILL (CONT'D)
It’s over for you. I’m the one you’re leaving in hell.

Things settle. Some quiet as Will works on Abe’s skull.

WILL (CONT'D)
It’s Will by the way.

Abe meets his eyes in the mirror.

WILL
Relax, Coyote.
(smirk)
You don’t need to show me yours.

Phone BUZZES again.

Will ties off the last stitch. Barks to the hallway:

WILL
Leyla!

Leyla rushes inside.

WILL (CONT'D)
Clean this up. Put on the bandage.

Will heads to the hall to answer the phone.

WILL
Salam alaykum.

Leyla takes grabs some gauze. Abe looks up at her.

ABE
Thank you.

Will SHUSHES them as he takes the call.

LEYLA
What he says?

Abe squints. What? Leyla mimics the finger-to-lips gesture.

LEYLA
“Shh”.

ABE
Oh. He’s just saying be quiet.

She mumbles SHH as she lays the bandage on Abe’s head.

LEYLA’S ROOM

Will takes the call inside Leyla’s room.

WILL
Sounds good. I’ll see you soon.

As he hangs up, something catches his eye--

Her English book. Open on the desk.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Moonlight on ancient bark. Fresh white grafts everywhere.

ROB
To home.

Sezen and Rob sit on a stone wall. Rakı bottle. Two glasses.

They clink their glasses.

SEZEN
Where's that for you?

ROB
Pennsylvania. But these days, I guess it’s wherever Terrasource wants to fund my work.

SEZEN
So you trust them?

ROB
I don’t really have a choice. It’s that or let all of this die.

He looks across the grove. At the trees.

ROB (CONT'D)
You ever think about leaving?

SEZEN
I actually did a semester at UT. Hook 'em.

ROB
(snort)
Seriously? Why’d you leave?

SEZEN
My mom.

Oh. She takes a long drink. He stays quiet.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Someone had to come back to take care of him. Of this.

ROB
They’re lucky to have you.

INT. WILL’S COMPOUND - GUEST BATHROOM - NIGHT

Shower running steamy water.

Abe hops in. Careful to avoid his bandaged head.

His scar runs from his throat, across his chest, over his shoulder. Like someone tried to cut him in half.

LEYLA'S ROOM - SAME

Downstairs, Leyla walks in to find the lights on. And:

WILL (O.S.)
I'm so impressed with you.

Will sitting at her desk, looking at her English books.

WILL (CONT'D)
English. What a language. So many words to say the same thing. So many meanings for the same words. Like "appreciate".

LEYLA
Thanking.

WILL
Right. But it also means to measure the value of something. Or someone.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen and Rob look at each other. Close.

WILL (V.O.)(CONT'D)
So when I say "I appreciate you", I could mean "I am thankful for you". Or, I could be saying...that I'm considering your worth. And Leyla--

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - LEYLA'S ROOM - NIGHT

Will lifts her English book--

WILL (CONT'D)
You're worth nothing to me dead.

The map of Hatay and family photos fall out.

LEYLA
I wasn't--

He ZAPS the cattle prod in his left hand.

WILL
Enough.

His eyes flash as he rises.

WILL (CONT'D)
They’re gone. All of them.

Tears run down her cheeks.

WILL (CONT'D)
I’m the only one who can protect you now.

He steps closer. Gentle now.

WILL (CONT'D)
Do you understand me?

She nods. Defeated. He touches her cheek. Then leaves.

She picks up the family photo from the floor.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Rob reaches for Sezen’s hand, but--

BUZZING from his pocket.

ROB
Sorry.

He checks his phone. Rises quickly. Concerned.

ROB
It’s the New York office.
(stepping away, answering)
Rob Green.
(listening)
Yes. I’m with her now.

His face drains of color.

ROB
What? What information?

He turns to Sezen. Horrified.

ROB (CONT’D)
Who’s Kaan?

Sezen goes cold.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BATHROOM - NIGHT

Abe stands under the water. Eyes closed.

DEMIR (PRE-LAP)
That's him. The man from the border.

Abe OPENS his eyes.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. HATAY HOTEL ROOM - NIGHT

ABE'S FACE in a photo from the port on Demir's laptop.

Now, he can clearly see the SCAR on his neck.

DEMIR (CONT'D)
I need to see him immediately.

Demir crosses to the wall. The faces of the dead. And ABE'S FACE. With the neck scar. From drone footage.

DEMIR (CONT'D)
Do you understand me?

Demir rubs his missing finger. Excited.

DEMIR (CONT'D)
I have to talk to him.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

MARCY listens to Demir's conversation.

DEMIR (V.O.)(CONT'D)
***Before* they torture him to death.**

MARCY
(under breath)
Fuck.

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - LEYLA'S ROOM - NIGHT

Leyla watches through the window, into the grove, where:

Will checks ammo in his handgun. Holsters it.

Grabs his phone, makes a call. Mumbles in Arabic.

GUEST BATHROOM

Abe's phone VIBRATES. He turns off the shower. Answers.

MARCY (PHONE)
Get out.
(beat)
Syrian Mukhabarat are on their way.

ABE
Why do you even care? I'm only here in case something goes wrong.

MARCY (PHONE)
Coyote.

GUEST BEDROOM

Someone steps in, approaches the bathroom door.

MARCY (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Something has gone wrong.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - SAME

Silence on the other line.

MARCY (CONT'D)
Coyote?

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BEDROOM - NIGHT

A KNIFE presses into Abe's throat.

MARCY (V.O.)
Coyote, are you there?

He drops the phone.

A dot of blood forms on his skin.

LEYLA (O.S.)
Shh.

ACT IV

INT. WILL'S COMPOUND - GUEST BEDROOM - NIGHT

Leyla holds the knife at Abe’s throat.

LEYLA
The man sells you. Tonight.

Abe studies her eyes. She’s not lying.

ABE
He’ll kill you for this.

LEYLA
Take me.

ABE
Then he’ll kill us both.

LEYLA
I don’t care. I have no one.

Abe opens his mouth. Her brother. In Turkey. But for some reason, he doesn’t say anything.

ABE
I can’t protect you.

Before she can respond--

WILL (O.S.)
Leyla?

Leyla turns to the door. Then back to Abe, whispering:

LEYLA
Stay.

She heads into the hall.

Abe exhales. Goes to the window. Opens it. Cool air rushes in. He looks back at the door to the hall.

INT. HEDGE FUND - KITCHEN - DAY

Kaan’s selecting some fiber snacks when his phone BUZZES in his pocket. It’s Sezen. He smiles.

KAAN
Hey. I was just thinking about you.

SEZEN (PHONE)
What the fuck did you do?

KAAN
What are you talking about?

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Rob's rental car pulls away. Taillights disappearing down the dirt road.

SEZEN (O.S.)
Rob got fired. Because of you.

Sezen watches from the grove. Bottle of rakı in hand.

KAAN (PHONE)
Sezen. I don’t understand.

SEZEN
You will.

INT. HEDGE FUND - DAY

Kaan walks out of the kitchen. Finds Peter standing at his desk. Two SECURITY GUARDS behind him.

KAAN
What are you doing?

PETER
Making a scene. So this never happens again.

Everyone on the floor goes quiet. Kaan checks around.

KAAN
I don’t know what’s going on.

PETER
Yes you do. That’s the problem. Your family tipped you off about Terrasource’s research and you tried to trade on that knowledge.

KAAN
(gulp)
Who told you that?

Kaan finally spots Jimmy, cowering in the corner.

PETER
I talked to the company, Kaan. They said your father just signed a contract to test their product on your family farm.

KAAN
What. He wouldn’t do that--

PETER (CONT'D)
Giving you access to material nonpublic information. And according to federal law, that’s insider trading.

KAAN
He wouldn’t do that. This is all a misunderstanding--

PETER
Save it for the SEC, or the DOJ, or ICE, or anyone else who gives a shit. Now get the fuck out.

Kaan looks back for Jimmy. He’s gone.

BATHROOM

Kaan barrels in.

KAAN
Jimmy!

Checks every stall one by one. Spots feet.

KAAN (CONT'D)
I see you.

He rips the door open. Finds the terrified Jimmy.

KAAN (CONT'D)
You ruined my fucking life.
(heaving)
What did you tell him?

JIMMY
The truth--

Kaan tackles him backward against the wall.

Throws him onto the floor. Within seconds--

Security Guards run in and wrestle him out to the floor.

EXT. WILL'S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Abe drops out of the window to the ground. Bag on shoulders.

This is the best chance he'll get.

He heads for the grove, but--

A GUN COCKS behind him.

He spins. Low. Fast. And--

The CATTLE PROD is already in his ribs.

ZAP. Abe hits the dirt. Every muscle locked.

WILL
Careful. There's jackals out there.

Will stands over him. Prod in one hand, gun in the other. He zaps Abe again. Longer. Abe stops moving.

Will kicks the bag away.

WILL (CONT'D)
You did this to yourself, Coyote. You drew eyes on me and put a price on your own head. Poor fucking spycraft, if you ask me.

Checks him for weapons. Then pulls out ROPES.

Pulls Abe's hands behind his back. Knots them. Fast.

ABE
I'm not a spy.

WILL
No.

Will sets Abe down against a tree. Runs the rope around the trunk. Cinches it.

WILL (CONT'D)
You're a prisoner now.

He tosses the cattle prod into the leaves.

WILL (CONT'D)
It'll be alright. Just breathe.

As he tucks the gun into his pants--

ZAP--

Will convulses. Drops. The gun falls in the dirt.

LEYLA stands over him. Cattle prod in her hand.

LEYLA
You owe me. Still.

From the ground, Abe sees: the scar on Leyla's ankle. Like a chain.

She goes for the gun--

Will's hand closes on that ankle.

She goes down hard. Onto fallen branches. Gashing her arm.

Abe pulls. The rope doesn't give.

Will crawls on top of Leyla. Sits on her chest. She can barely breathe.

WILL
He can't protect you like I can.
He's a fucking war criminal they fished out of a prison in Mosul.
Someone to burn if things go bad.
(back to English)
Tell her.

Abe looks into Leyla's eyes. A long silence.

ABE
Your brother's alive.

Will snaps to Abe.

WILL
What the fuck are you doing?

Leyla's hand finds a branch.

LEYLA STABS Will's neck with the branch.

BLOOD spurts from his jugular.

He falls forward onto Leyla. His full weight trapping her.

INT. NYPD - INTERVIEW ROOM - EVENING

Kaan is cuffed to the table when his LAWYER enters.

LAWYER
They're giving you a desk ticket. You'll be out tonight. Court date's in two months.

KAAN
I need to get back to my family.

LAWYER
If you leave the country now, you’re never getting back in.

KAAN
Just get me a fucking phone.

INT. YILMAZ FARMHOUSE - DAVUT’S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Davut’s phone sings and glows.

Finally, he rustles awake. Answers:

DAVUT
Kaan?

KAAN (PHONE)
Baba. Did you sign a contract? With an American company?
(beat)
Or was it her?

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Sezen sits alone on the stone wall, drunk. The rakı bottle. Two glasses. She drinks from Rob’s.

Behind her, the back door opens.

She doesn’t turn around. Pours another.

DAVUT

crosses the yard in his nightclothes. Barefoot. Phone in his breast pocket.

EQUIPMENT SHED

Davut opens the wooden chest.

Pushes aside the old revolver.

Grabs the AXE.

MUSA’S TENT

Musa wakes to crunching leaves.

Davut’s shadow passes over the tent. The shadow of the axe looks enormous in the moonlight.

EXT. WILL’S COMPOUND - OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Leyla trapped under Will's body. Blood drips on her face.

She pushes. Can’t move him. Can barely breathe.

ABE

pulls at the ropes. Nothing.

Then he stops. His eyes on the trees behind Leyla.

ABE
Don’t move.

LEYLA

hears the PANTING. Getting closer.

She can’t turn her head. But she can feel the HOT BREATH on her head. Then--

A JACKAL’s face appears above her.

It licks Will’s blood from his neck.

A DROP lands on her forehead. Warm. Thick.

She cries with no sound, staring upward at the jackal’s yellow eyes. Teeth. A low GROWL from its throat.

ABE

hisses and grunts, trying to get the jackal’s attention. When it finally looks up, Abe notices: a bullet wound in its side.

The jackal holds its eyes on Abe for a moment.

Then lowers its head back to Leyla’s face. Just then--

Its ears perk up.

Suddenly, the sound of ENGINES get closer.

HEADLIGHTS sweep through the trees.

A TRUCK pulls in the driveway. Doors.

DRIVEWAY

Three SYRIAN INTELLIGENCE OFFICERS drag their flashlights around the dark house.

OFFICER 1
They said he'd be back here.

They proceed back into the:

OLIVE GROVE

Leyla sees the flashlights illuminating the rows.

Getting closer.

The jackal looks back down at Leyla...

...then disappears into the trees.

THE OFFICERS

stop. Listen...to:

RUSTLING in the trees.

A flashlight swings to a trunk. Lands on YELLOW EYES.

OFFICER 1
What the--

The jackal LUNGES at the Officer. BITES his forearm.

He SCREAMS. The flashlight drops.

LEYLA

hears the SNARLING. Screaming. SHOTS FIRED.

OFFICER 2 (O.S.)
Get him to the truck! I'll find the American.

The flashlights jumble in a panic.

One beam stays. Jittery. Sweeping toward where the jackal went. Away from her.

ABE
(whisper)
Now. Let's go.

Leyla pushes upward, but he's too heavy.

The flashlight turns in their direction.

ABE
Leyla. Hurry.

She wedges her knee under Will's hip. Rocks the body. Once. Twice. Teeth bared.

Will THUDS into the leaves.

The beam whips toward the sound.

She freezes. It sweeps the next row over. Moves on.

ABE
Just go.

But Leyla climbs to her knees. Then to Abe. Tears at the knot behind the trunk. Then the one at his wrists.

THE OFFICER

reaches the spot.

Leyla, Abe, and Abe's bag are gone.

But Will's body lies in a pool of blood. Face down.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

Drunk, Sezen stares into the grove. Lifts her glass when she hears--

CHOPPING in the distance.

She drops down off the wall. Unsteady.

CHOP CHOP

She follows the sound through the dark trees.

SEZEN
Baba?

CHOPPING getting louder as she finds:

Davut attacking an ancient tree with an axe. Shirt soaked with sweat. Eyes wild.

SEZEN (CONT'D)
Baba, stop--

CRACK. Axe bites into healthy wood.

She grabs the axe.

He doesn't let go.

DAVUT
My name. My father's name. Seven generations. You put it on a lie.

Sezen doesn't respond. He grips his chest in agony.

SEZEN
I'm saving our grove--

DAVUT
You buried us. You brought the wolves in. Foreign poison.

He RIPS the axe away from her. Some unknown strength.

DAVUT
Where is it?

He staggers toward another tree. Nearly falls.

Catches himself on the trunk. Breathing hard. Looks around wildly. Then he sees it.

DAVUT
There.

He lurches toward a tree with fresh grafting tape around the trunk. The foreign scion wood joined to ancient roots.

Then grips the axe tighter. Raises it high and--

CRACK.

The axe splits through the graft joint.

Foreign wood splinters.

SEZEN
Baba. Please. Listen to me--

CRACK. Davut's axe bites deeper into the grafted wood.

SEZEN
(crying now)
You're going to kill it.

DAVUT
It's already dead!

He raises the axe again.

Sezen grabs the axe mid-swing.

They struggle. His fevered strength shocking her.

SEZEN
You said it, Baba. We have to make hard choices. For our family.

He stops. Looks at her.

DAVUT
You are not my family.

He SHOVES her hard.

Sezen falls BACKWARD onto the ground.

Davut turns back to the tree.

Raises the axe high over the graft--

Sezen grabs his ankle. Holds it.

Then YANKS it.

Davut's weak body can't compensate--

His HEAD CRACKS against the tree trunk.

A sickening sound.

He hangs against the trunk. Then slides down it.

Crumples at the foot of the tree.

Blood pours from the front of his head...

...down the bark.

Silence.

SEZEN
Baba?

Nothing. Davut’s shape at the foot of the tree. Still.

She rolls to get up. Her right arm doesn’t come with her.

She screams into her teeth. Looks down. The shoulder sits wrong. Out of its socket.

She tries again. Left arm only. Gets a knee under her. The ground tilts and she goes down on her face. Dirt in her teeth. His blood on the ground, inches away.

No one is coming.

She stops. Lays her cheek on the ground. And closes her eyes.

The TREE above her RUSTLES. Her eyes open.

She digs her elbow in. Drags herself a foot closer.

Reaches for Davut’s sleeve. Falls short.

Lunges forward. Finally grabs his shirt.

She rolls Davut onto his back.

She bends over him. Breathes into his mouth.

Pumps his chest with her working arm.

One. Two. Three.

SEZEN
Come on. Come on.

Breathes again. Pumps. Nothing.

SEZEN
Baba. Please.

Nothing. She stops. Pulls him close across her chest.

SEZEN
Baba.

Blood pools beneath them. Seeping into the roots.

INT./EXT. DEMIR'S CAR - MOUNTAIN ROAD - NIGHT

Headlights carve a switchback toward the border.

Demir drives one-handed. Phone to his ear.

DEMIR
I said I need him alive.

He gets another call from ELIF. Ignores it.

Drives faster.

INT. CIA FIELD OFFICE - LOCATION UNDISCLOSED - NIGHT

Marcy monitors Demir's call.

CONTACT (PHONE)
That's up to God now.

She tosses the headset.

Then SMACKS the bowl of pistachio shells across the room.

Grabs her phone. Makes another call. Breathes. Nervous.

MARCY
He's gone.

VOICE (PHONE)
And?

Marcy packs up her computer.

VOICE (PHONE)
You knew the risk. He's not ours.
We can't ask for him back.

MARCY
I'm not asking.

She hangs up. Zips her bag.

EXT. SYRIAN HILLSIDE - NIGHT

Abe and Leyla climb through the trees.

Far below, flashlights cross Will's grove.

ABE
(gasping for breath)
Thank you.

Leyla doesn't respond.

Abe grabs her arm.

She swings back to him but he puts his hands up. Then carefully pulls out a cloth from his bag. Unwraps the wild yarrow. Holds up Leyla's gashed arm.

He packs the open wound with the flowers. Ties the cloth around it tightly.

LEYLA
What now?

ABE
Your brother. Will said he's working on an olive grove.

LEYLA
Hatay.

Abe nods. Then starts walking toward the dark mountains.

ABE
Hurry. We need to get over the border before daybreak.

She looks up at the moon.

LEYLA
I'm coming for you...

Then follows Abe up the hill. Toward the moon.

MATCH CUT TO:

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - NIGHT

The same moon. Shining onto Musa, who hides behind a tree.

LEYLA (V.O.) (CONT'D)
...*Musa*.

Sezen, holding Davut's body in her arms, finally notices Musa standing there. They make eye contact. *What did he see?*

BUZZ BUZZ

She checks her pockets. Nothing. Then feels it against her, in Davut's breast pocket.

She looks back at Musa.

Puts her finger to her lips. Shh.

INT. JFK AIRPORT - NIGHT

Kaan waits in line, phone to ear. The call is answered.

KAAN
Baba?

No response.

KAAN (CONT'D)
Baba. I'm on my way home.

Still no response.

But Kaan can hear the WIND rustling through the leaves and branches. The sound of the grove. It settles him.

KAAN (CONT'D)
We can fix this.

SEZEN (PHONE)
No. We can't.

EXT. YILMAZ OLIVE GROVE - DAWN

Sezen hangs up Davut's phone.

Then holds him tight in her lap.

His blood dried into the roots of the trees.

The tree rustles in response...

...and for the first time this year...

...<u>the branches seem to grow</u>.

HOWLING in the distance--

CUT TO BLACK.